Township of NIPISSING
"Life the way it should be" ESTABLISHED 1888

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REPORT TO COUNCIL

Date: January 6, 2026

From: Kim Turnbull, Deputy Treasurer, Office Assistant

Re: Employee Benefit Package Renewal

Background:

The Township of Nipissing offers a comprehensive employee benefit program to full-time staff comprising of health care, paramedical, dental, life insurance and short and long-term disability.

The Township works with Meldrum Horne to ensure the Township is offered a competitive rate and comprehensive program for its employees.

In 2024 and 2025 the yearly premiums did not increase for the employee benefit package. Meldrum Horne has been able to secure the same rate for the Township for the employee benefit program for 2026, with Canada Life; the Township's benefit provider.

Summary:

Along with the comprehensive benefit program staff are able to access additional resources including Virtual Health Care - Consult+, savings at Rexall and more.

To improve benefits, to assist staff, in continuing to manage their health, we recommend the addition of a Health Spending Account (HSA). This a flexible addition to the current package which will allow for the use of an additional $500.00 per staff member towards expenses required for their or their dependents' circumstances.

This approach to address increasing healthcare costs provides minimal increase to the program costs and allows for individual spending requirements rather than blanket increases to the benefit packages and potential costs that may not be utilized by all members.

This program would increase the benefit program cost $7,898 per year. As the amount is used as required, any surplus at year end can be placed into a reserve to offset other related costs in the future.

Recommendation:

That Council approve the addition of a HSA to the staff benefit package for 2026.

Respectfully,

Kim Turnbull,
Deputy Treasurer, Office Assistant